



The One-Page Memo

A decision that cannot be written on one page is not finished. The academy uses five lines. If a line is empty, the decision is not ready to be taken, filed, or defended.

Line 1 — Object

Name the instrument, the venue, and the horizon in one sentence. Not the sector story. The object.

Line 2 — Claim

The falsifiable statement. ‘X will happen because Y, and I will know I was wrong if Z prints.’ Without Z, it is not a claim.

Line 3 — Other side

Who is on the other side of the trade and why they are willing. If you cannot name them, you do not have a market — you have a wish.

Line 4 — Risk inventory

What you can lose, in units of money and in units of time, and which layer produces the loss. Cap first. Thesis second.

Line 5 — Plumbing

How the trade is booked, margined, settled, and closed. If this line is vague, the first four lines are theatre.



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HOUSE RULES

- One memo per decision. Do not staple two trades together to make the story prettier.
- Date the memo. A claim without a clock is not a claim.
- When the falsifier prints, the memo is closed. Do not rewrite history in the same file.
- Office hours exist to pressure-test Line 3 and Line 4, not to decorate Line 2.
- The binder is the record. A conversation is not the record.

BLANK FIVE-LINE PAD

1. Object

2. Claim

3. Other side

4. Risk

5. Plumbing